Hayat Dahraj
February 15, 2026

CONTEXT

This interview supports my proposal for Project Clara, a mobile application designed to consolidate school communication for Denton K-12 public schools. The app would use React Native and AWS to provide parents with real-time visibility into their child's day while reducing administrative burdens for teachers. The purpose of this interview was to assess the technical feasibility of the proposed architecture and identify potential challenges the development team may face.

I interviewed Indira Devi Siripurapu, a Ph.D. Candidate in the Smart Electronic Systems Lab at the University of North Texas Department of Computer Science and Engineering. Ms. Siripurapu serves as the technical advisor for my capstone team developing Project Clara and has experience working with AWS and React Native in both research and academic contexts. The interview was conducted via email on February 15, 2026. Ms. Siripurapu can be reached at IndiraDeviSiripurapu@my.unt.edu.

AUTHENTICATING THE INTERVIEW

The following items verify Ms. Siripurapu's professional identity and confirm our interview exchange.

Figure 1: LinkedIn profile showing Ms. Siripurapu's role as Teaching Assistant at UNT and Ph.D. in Computer Science

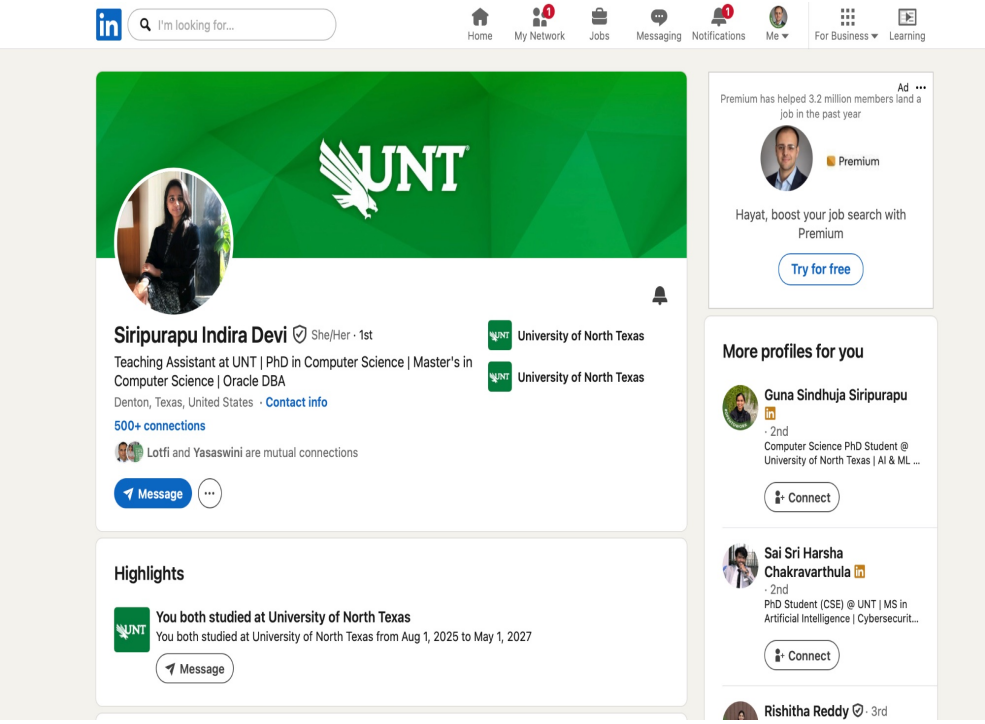
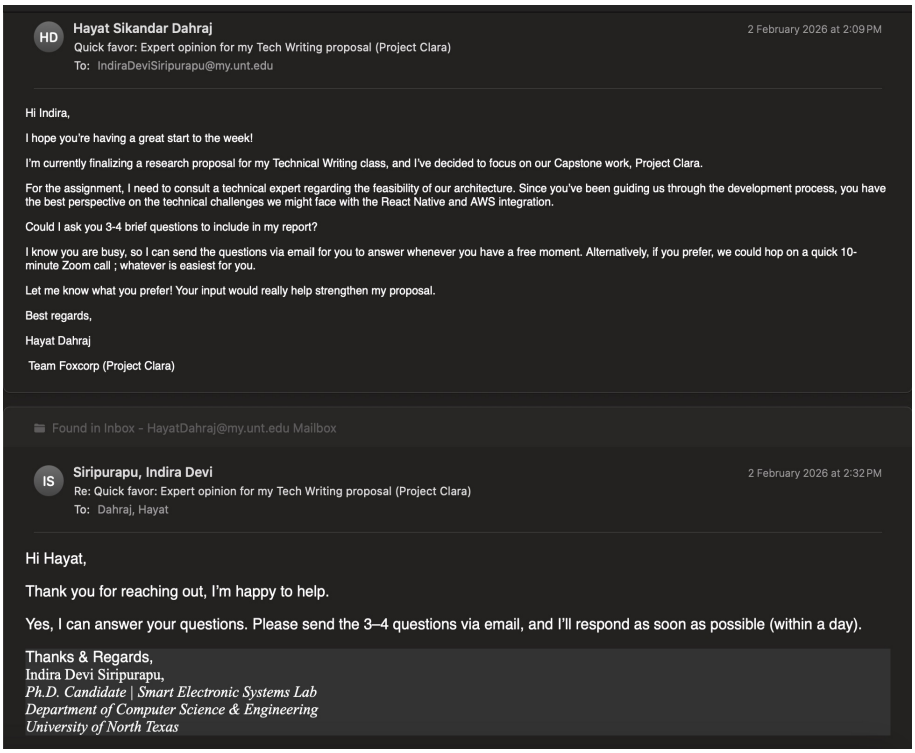


Figure 2: Email thread showing initial outreach (February 2, 2026) and Ms. Siripurapu's agreement to participate



HD **Hayat Sikandar Dahraj** 2 February 2026 at 2:09 PM
Quick favor: Expert opinion for my Tech Writing proposal (Project Clara)
To: IndiraDeviSiripurapu@my.unt.edu

Hi Indira,

I hope you're having a great start to the week!

I'm currently finalizing a research proposal for my Technical Writing class, and I've decided to focus on our Capstone work, Project Clara.

For the assignment, I need to consult a technical expert regarding the feasibility of our architecture. Since you've been guiding us through the development process, you have the best perspective on the technical challenges we might face with the React Native and AWS integration.

Could I ask you 3-4 brief questions to include in my report?

I know you are busy, so I can send the questions via email for you to answer whenever you have a free moment. Alternatively, if you prefer, we could hop on a quick 10-minute Zoom call ; whatever is easiest for you.

Let me know what you prefer! Your input would really help strengthen my proposal.

Best regards,

Hayat Dahraj

Team Foxcorp (Project Clara)

Found in Inbox - HayatDahraj@my.unt.edu Mailbox

IS **Siripurapu, Indira Devi** 2 February 2026 at 2:32 PM
Re: Quick favor: Expert opinion for my Tech Writing proposal (Project Clara)
To: Dahraj, Hayat

Hi Hayat,

Thank you for reaching out, I'm happy to help.

Yes, I can answer your questions. Please send the 3–4 questions via email, and I'll respond as soon as possible (within a day).

Thanks & Regards,
Indira Devi Siripurapu,
Ph.D. Candidate | Smart Electronic Systems Lab
Department of Computer Science & Engineering
University of North Texas

MAIN TAKEAWAYS

Scope Management and MVP Strategy

Ms. Siripurapu emphasized the importance of building a focused first version rather than attempting to implement all features at once. She noted that Project Clara operates in a "high responsibility" area because it involves real-time child location data and student records. When asked about her concerns with the design, she stated, "I'd rather you build a smaller version that works really well than a big version that's unreliable." She recommended that a realistic first version include login with roles, student roster, schedule assignments, and a clean interface for teachers to update student status. Full real-time GPS tracking, she suggested, should be deferred unless extra time remains.

Data Security for Sensitive Student Information

Given that Project Clara will handle medical records, emergency contacts, and location data for minors, Ms. Siripurapu provided clear guidance on security practices. She advised, "For this kind of data, assume it's sensitive and treat it carefully from day one." Her specific recommendations included storing only necessary data, encrypting information in transit and at rest, implementing

strict role-based access so parents only see their child and staff only see what they need, maintaining audit logs, and avoiding hardcoded secrets in the app. She concluded that even as a class project, the app "should look like something a school IT/security team wouldn't panic about."

Cross-Platform Development Challenges

Ms. Siripurapu cautioned against underestimating platform-specific differences when building for both iPhone and Android. She identified background location tracking as the hardest technical challenge, explaining that "iPhones are especially strict about tracking when the app isn't open" and Android presents battery and permission issues. Regarding common mistakes, she observed, "The biggest mistake is assuming 'cross-platform' means 'no platform problems.'" She recommended extensive testing on real devices and building fallbacks like "last updated at" timestamps for cases when notifications are delayed or blocked by device settings.

REFLECTION

This interview significantly shaped my understanding of what a feasible proposal for Project Clara should include. Ms. Siripurapu's emphasis on scope management confirmed that my proposal should recommend a phased approach, starting with core functionality before adding advanced features like continuous GPS tracking. Her security recommendations will directly inform the implementation requirements I include in my proposal, particularly around encryption, role-based access, and audit logging.

The interview raised new questions about integration with existing school communication systems. Ms. Siripurapu noted that she was unsure what platforms Denton schools currently use and whether those systems have accessible APIs. This suggests I should research current Denton ISD communication tools and potentially include integration feasibility as a secondary research component. Additionally, her comments about designing for multi-school scalability from the start will influence how I frame the proposal's long-term vision.